Can Deveci

Lead AI Engineer

Contact Information

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- **Location**: Amsterdam, Netherlands
- **Work Authorization**: Permanent EU Residency (no sponsorship required)

Professional Experience

Lead AI Engineer *Spotzer Digital | March 2021 – Present*

- **Lead the 22-person technical team**, owning AI engineering direction, architecture decisions, and delivery standards across the company's platform
- Own the AI/NLP roadmap with product and executive stakeholders: RAG pipelines, agentic content workflows, and classification systems behind ad targeting
- Built a context-aware website content generation system (RAG, LangChain, Milvus), eliminating **~$120K/year** in prior manual/agency content costs
- Redesigned AWS infrastructure (Lambda, ECS, ECR, DynamoDB), cutting monthly compute spend by **~40%**
- Built AI-powered social post generation, review, and publishing pipeline (GPT-4o, Claude, FastAPI)
- Delivered ad taxonomy translation and business category detection ML systems
- Built internal tools and customer-facing apps with Next.js, React, and Clerk authentication
- Mentor engineers, run code reviews, and manage full development cycles (Agile/Scrum: Jira, Confluence, CI/CD via Azure DevOps)

NLP Engineer *Sestek | October 2018 – February 2021*

- Built production sentiment classifiers (BERT, RoBERTa) for customer interaction analysis
- Developed intent classification for banking and telecom, including agglutinative-language handling (Turkish); related work published, see Publications
- Implemented T5/BART-based text summarization and translation systems
- Benchmarked embedding techniques that informed product roadmap decisions

Full Stack Developer *Sestek | December 2017 – September 2018*

- Built an intent-detection web tool for banking and telecom (.NET MVC, JavaScript, Node.js)
- Developed RESTful APIs and web applications with .NET Core, Entity Framework, and React.js
- Optimized MSSQL databases through query tuning and indexing
- Implemented unit testing (NUnit) and integration testing (Selenium), achieving **70% test coverage**

Skills

Core, daily use: Python, LangChain, LangGraph, PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, OpenAI & Anthropic APIs, Milvus, AWS (Lambda, ECS, ECR, DynamoDB), Azure Cloud, Docker

Production experience: FastAPI, Next.js, React (Redux, Context API), MSSQL, DynamoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, Terraform, PyTest, CloudWatch

NLP fundamentals: BERT, RoBERTa, T5, BART, sentence embeddings, TF-IDF, cross-encoder re-ranking

Applied, less deep: CrewAI, PydanticAI, DSPy, LlamaIndex, Pinecone, GitHub Actions, Sentry, GraphQL, OAuth 2.0

Day-to-day agentic tooling: Claude Code, Cursor, MCP-based workflows

Languages: Python (7+ yrs), JavaScript/TypeScript, C#, SQL, Bash

Other tools: Git/Gitflow, Jira, Confluence, Postman, NumPy/Pandas, BeautifulSoup/Scrapy

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Education

M.Sc. in Electrical and Electronics Engineering *Boğaziçi University, Istanbul | GPA: 3.63 | 2019 – 2022*

- **Thesis**: *Design and Implementation of a Response Retrieval and Re-ranking System* — two-stage TF-IDF + Cross-Encoder retrieval pipeline for conversational AI; showed smaller task-specific transformers outperforming larger general-purpose models on retrieval; extended to open-domain QA without task-specific fine-tuning

B.Sc. in Electrical and Electronics Engineering *Boğaziçi University, Istanbul | 2011 – 2017*

- Ranked 116th in National University Entrance Exam (Top 0.01% of ~1.8M candidates, 2011)

Publications

- *Intent Classification with Short Sentences in Agglutinative Languages* (2020) — NLP techniques for intent detection in morphologically rich languages such as Turkish

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Recognition

- Employee of the Month, Spotzer Digital — February 2022, February 2023
- Machine Learning Certificate, Stanford University (Coursera, 2017)
- Natural Language Processing in TensorFlow, Coursera (2020)
- Team Captain, Mediterranean Math Olympics (2008)

Activities

- Volunteer, Amsterdam Art Week 2023 (Amsterdam Art Foundation)
- Organized charity events for war victims from several countries